



TULIS

Market Analysis and Competitive Strategy

Market size, competitors, user needs, differentiation, and launch implications

Research cut-off: 24 September 2026\Prepared for product, strategy, engineering, and investment decisions

Executive conclusion TULIS is entering a validated but crowded group-expense category adjacent to a very large travel economy. The defensible opportunity is not a headline percentage of global travel bookings or UPI volume. It is a focused workflow: an organizer creates a trip, participants join with low friction, expenses remain correct through offline edits and unequal participation, refunds are propagated transparently, and balances end in an auditable settlement. TULIS can be ahead where it proves this end-to-end workflow with event-sourced accounting, travel-native context, reliable offline reconciliation, and India-relevant payment hand-off.

One Trip. One Ledger. Zero Confusion.

Group trip finances without the spreadsheets.

Connect your itinerary with an immutable financial ledger. Invite squad members with a 6-character code (e.g. **GOA2026**), upload bill receipts, and compress group debts via greedy zero-sum graph netting.

[+ Create Custom Trip](#)
[Join with Invite Code](#)
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Net 0.00

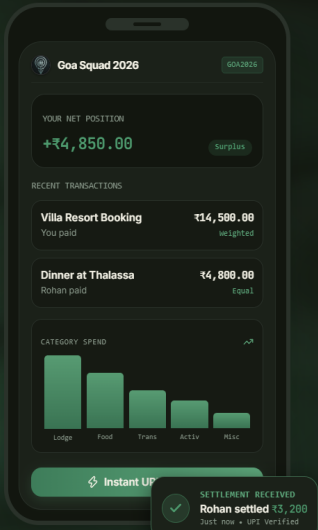
Zero-Sum Audit

Minimal Paths

Debt Compression

₹ INR UPI

Instant QR Settle



Goa Squad 2026 GOA2026

YOUR NET POSITION
+₹4,850.00 Surplus

RECENT TRANSACTIONS

Transaction	Amount	Status
Villa Resort Booking	₹14,500.00	weighted
Dinner at Thalassa	₹4,800.00	equal

CATEGORY SPEND

Category	Spend
Lodge	High
Food	Medium
Trans	Low
Activ	Low
Misc	Low

Instant UP

SETTLEMENT RECEIVED
Rohan settled ₹3,200
Just now • UPI Verified

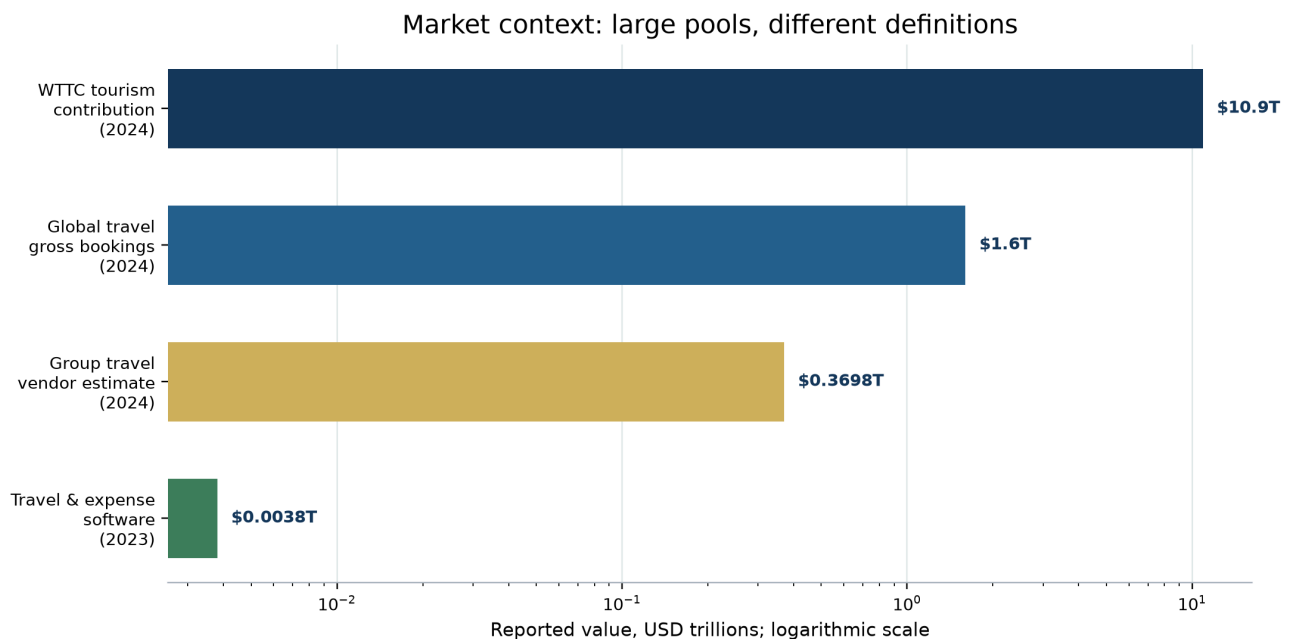
1 Scope, method, and key definitions

This report synthesizes public market, company, government, app-store, and user-signal sources reviewed on 24 September 2026. It separates activity pools from software revenue and distinguishes sourced evidence from TULIS hypotheses. Figures are shown with their original geography, date, unit, and market definition.

Term	Meaning in this report
TAM	The total theoretical market under a stated definition. A travel-spend pool is not automatically software TAM.
SAM	The reachable segment after geography, target user, product scope, distribution, and payment constraints.
SOM	The portion TULIS could realistically capture over a stated period based on distribution and unit economics.
Activity pool	Money or trips flowing through the broader behavior, such as bookings or UPI transactions.
Software market	Revenue paid for software; this report keeps enterprise T&E and consumer group expense categories separate.
Evidence quality	Operator claims and store signals indicate presence; they do not prove active users, retention, revenue, or market share.

2 Market landscape and sizing

2.1 The market is large, but the numbers are not additive



Sources: WTTC; Phocuswright; Market Research Future; Grand View Research. These values are not additive and are not TULIS TAM.

Figure 1: Market context across different definitions. The values are deliberately not presented as a combined TAM. Phocuswright estimates worldwide travel gross bookings at \$1.6 trillion in 2024 and nearly \$1.8 trillion by 2027. Its separate outlook estimated online travel gross bookings at \$1.0 trillion in 2024 and forecast \$1.2 trillion by 2026. These figures describe booking flow across travel sectors and channels, not group-expense software revenue. [1] [2] WTTC reported \$10.9 trillion in 2024 Travel & Tourism contribution to the global economy, including direct, indirect, and induced effects. It separately cited \$5.3 trillion in domestic and \$1.87 trillion in international visitor spending. These are economic-impact and visitor-spending measures, not substitutes for gross bookings or TULIS revenue. [3] [4]

A commercial Market Research Future estimate places the global group-travel market at \$369.8 billion in 2024 and \$391.36 billion in 2025. The definition includes leisure, corporate, educational, event, and religious travel. Because

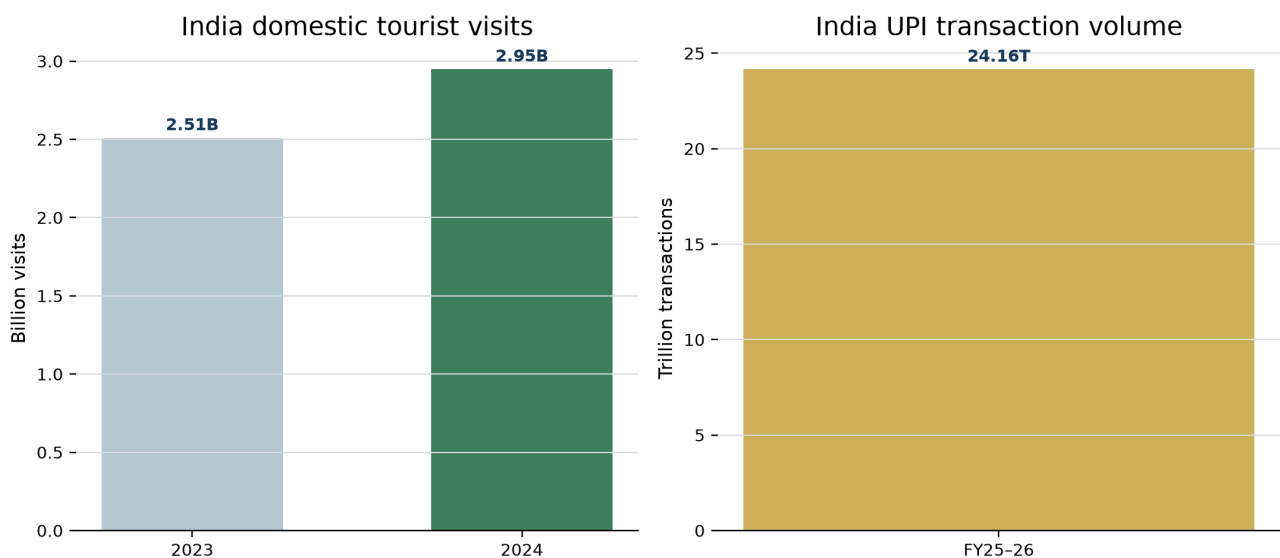
the report page contains inconsistent endpoints and broad scope, the value is best used as a directional activity-pool indicator. [5]

Grand View Research estimates global travel-and-expense management software at \$3.8 billion in 2023 and forecasts \$10.69 billion by 2030. This is an enterprise-facing category covering travel, expense, and invoice management. It is adjacent context, not a consumer group-trip TAM. [7] A separate Technavio forecast cites a \$423.6 million bill-splitting-app opportunity over 2024–2028, but the public summary does not expose enough methodology to treat it as audited category revenue. [8]

Market-sizing decision Do not add travel GDP, travel bookings, group-travel forecasts, enterprise T&E software, bill-splitting forecasts, and UPI throughput into one headline. TULIS's monetizable market must be built bottom-up from reachable groups, trip frequency, eligible expenses, pricing or payment economics, retention, and cost to serve.

2.2 India as an initial wedge

India context: travel activity and payment infrastructure



Tourist visits are not unique travelers; UPI includes non-travel payments. Sources: India Tourism Data Compendium 2025; Government/NPCI release.

Figure 2: India travel activity and payment infrastructure; neither series is travel-specific software demand. India recorded 2,948.19 million domestic tourist visits in 2024, up 17.51% from 2023. Visits are not unique travelers, groups, app users, or expense transactions. The figure supports domestic travel as a discovery market, not a direct SAM calculation. [9]

A government release attributed to NPCI reported 24,161.69 crore UPI transactions worth approximately ₹314 lakh crore in FY2025–26, with 703 banks live as of March 2026. Business Standard and Reuters reported August 2026 UPI volume and value of 24.51 billion transactions and ₹29.82 trillion. UPI is powerful enabling infrastructure, but these national totals include non-travel payments and cannot be used as TULIS payment volume. [11] [12] [13]

The strategic implication is a focused hypothesis: Indian friends-and-family trips may be a strong environment for a shared ledger plus UPI hand-off. It still requires primary validation of trip frequency, participant count, expense mix, guest participation, settlement behavior, and willingness to pay.

3 Competitive landscape

3.1 Category baseline

Offline entry, multi-currency handling, custom splits, receipt capture, exports, balance calculation, and debt simplification are already represented across the category. TULIS must therefore lead with workflow quality and correctness, not feature-count novelty.

Product	Core expense workflow	Travel / offline	Audit and change handling	Settlement
Splitwise	Flexible splits, multiple payers, debt simplification	Offline, trips, multi-currency	CSV and product history; refund cascade not established	Market-dependent integrations
Tricount	Custom splits, receipt photos	Offline, trips, multi-currency	Export and sync concerns appear in anecdotal reviews	Settlement suggestions
TravelSpend	Payer/beneficiary allocation, budgets	Offline, travel-first, home currency	CSV; transfer recording	Recorded transfers
Splid	Unequal splits, group sharing	Offline, multi-currency	PDF/Excel summaries	Not established
Settle Up	Weighted splits, multiple payers	Offline, browser access	CSV/Excel, minimal transfers	Not established
Expensify	OCR, approvals, reimbursements	Travel plus enterprise workflows	Corporate controls and integrations	Cards and reimbursements
TULIS	Six methods, AI with review, duplicate guard	Trip-native, offline-first	Event history, refund cascades, audit PDF/CSV	UPI hand-off tied to balance

The table is a directional public-feature comparison, not a claim that competitors lack capabilities not documented on the reviewed pages. “Planned” marks TULIS product intent that still requires implementation and benchmarking.

3.2 Competitor profiles

3.2.1 Splitwise

Splitwise is the strongest general shared-expense benchmark. It supports flexible allocation, multiple payers, offline entry, debt simplification, CSV export, and a travel use case. Its free tier currently limits users to four expenses per day, while Pro adds receipt scanning, itemization, search, currency conversion, charts, and default splits. Its official pages show payment options vary by market; the reviewed material does not establish current UPI coverage. [15] [16] [17]

TULIS should not claim that Splitwise lacks audit history or refund handling without direct product testing. The opportunity is to make event provenance, refund redistribution, and trip-linked anomalies visible as first-class workflow elements.

3.2.2 Tricount

Tricount sets a strong free-core benchmark with offline entry, custom splits, multi-currency tracking, receipt photos, and settlement suggestions. bunq reported nearly €16.4 billion shared across 175 countries in 2024, based on nearly 16 million users. Current pages show conflicting user-count claims, so the scale should be treated as operator-reported evidence, not audited market share. Reviews mentioning sync or export concerns are anecdotal. [18] [19] [20]

TULIS must make its reliability advantage observable: conflict-safe edits, clear reconciliation states, durable exports, and visible event history.

3.2.3 TravelSpend

TravelSpend is the closest travel-budgeting comparator. It combines offline entry, home-currency conversion, shared trips, cost splitting, map-linked expenses, budgeting, and CSV export. Its help center describes recording transfers between travelers rather than proving integrated payment execution. Public storefront signals show meaningful reach, but not active users, revenue, or retention. [21] [22]

TULIS’s opportunity is to link the itinerary and booking context to a stronger accounting model, especially when participants join late, leave early, or receive a partial refund.

3.2.4 Splid and Settle Up

Splid and Settle Up demonstrate that sign-up-light collaboration, offline use, multi-payer or weighted splits, multi-currency support, and exports are category expectations. Settle Up also promotes minimal-transfer settlement and browser access for invitees. These products compress the space for a generic splitter and support TULIS’s decision to focus on travel-native events and change management. [23] [24]

3.2.5 Expensify

Expensify is an adjacent enterprise benchmark rather than a direct consumer group-trip analogue. It combines receipt capture, approvals, reimbursements, cards, travel, bill pay, invoices, chat, and accounting integrations. Expensify reported FY2025 revenue of \$142.1 million and Q4 paid members of 650,000. Its scale demonstrates the value of automation and integrations, but its company-spend model should not be used to size TULIS's consumer market. [25] [26]

4 Where TULIS can be ahead

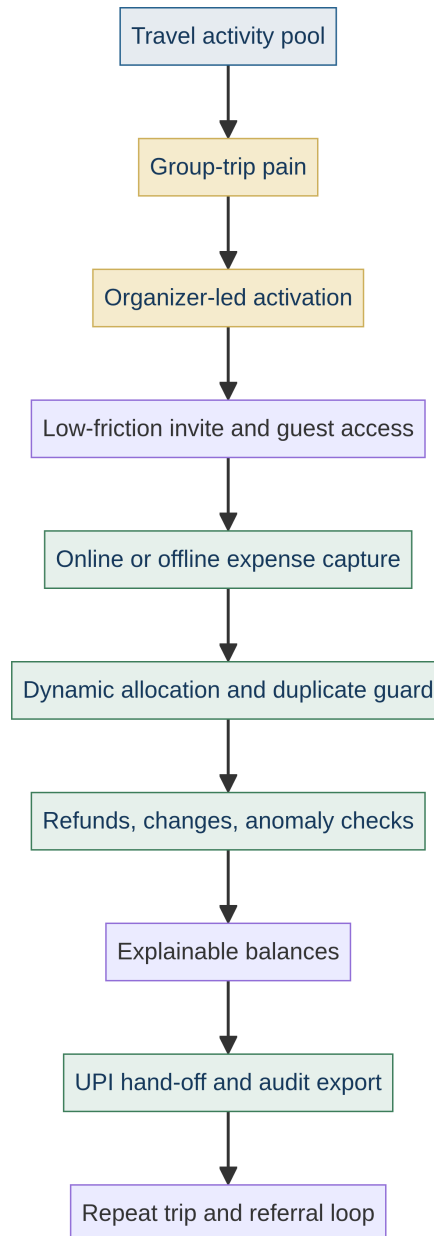


Figure 3: Hypothesized TULIS wedge from trip activity to repeatable, auditable settlement.

4.1 Differentiation thesis

1. **Trip-first accounting:** expenses, bookings, itinerary events, participants, and refunds share one context.
2. **Event-sourced correctness:** every accepted change is attributable and replayable; balances are derived rather than hand-edited.
3. **Complex-change handling:** dynamic splits, partial attendance, cancellation policies, proportional relief, and rounding preservation are part of the core model.
4. **Explainable automation:** AI parses language and suggests structure, but users confirm data and deterministic rules govern money.

5. **Resilient collaboration:** offline queues, idempotent replay, conflict visibility, duplicate guards, and zero-sum reconciliation protect trust.
6. **India-localized settlement:** optional UPI hand-off links outstanding balances to the last-mile payment action, subject to provider validation and regulatory review.

What “ahead” means The research supports a **potential** TULIS advantage, not a proven one. TULIS is ahead only when pilots demonstrate better completion, fewer corrections, clearer refund outcomes, and higher settlement success on real trips than the users’ current mix of spreadsheets, chat messages, and generic splitters.

4.2 Comparison of defensibility

Dimension	Current category baseline	TULIS hypothesis	Proof required
Capture	Manual entry, photos, some OCR/AI	Natural language plus receipt-to-ledger trace	Time to first correct expense; edit rate
Allocation	Equal/custom/weighted options	Six travel-specific methods and cent-safe rules	Correction rate; unresolved allocation count
Change handling	Edits, recorded transfers, varying histories	Refund cascades and replayable events	Refund resolution time; disputes
Reliability	Offline advertised by multiple apps	Conflict-safe queue and zero-sum audit	Sync failure rate; duplicate events
Settlement	Suggestions or recorded transfers; regional rails	UPI hand-off tied to outstanding balance	Payment initiation-to-reconciliation completion
Trust	Exports and app-level history vary	Audit PDF, CSV, event trail, role control	Export use; support contacts; repeat use

5 Actual user needs and market signals

5.1 What users appear to need

Public surveys and product evidence point to five recurring needs. First, group travel takes significant planning time: a Priceline/Harris Poll survey reported an average of 16 hours to plan and book a trip, with 22% naming itinerary creation among the most frustrating parts. [27] Second, budget anxiety is common: a commercial Go City survey reported 44% worry about overspending. [28] Third, money creates social strain: an Experian survey of travelers reported money-related disagreements and friendship impact, although sampling details and subgroup bases are limited. [29]

Fourth, users need low-friction participation. Generic expense apps create value only when enough of the group can contribute or view the ledger; guest access and shareable summaries may matter as much as account creation. Fifth, users need confidence when the trip changes: offline edits, partial attendance, refunds, currency conversion, and corrections should not create a second social negotiation about the numbers.

Observed need	Why it matters	TULIS product response
Fairness	Different people consume different rooms, meals, and activities	Dynamic split methods with human-readable preview
Low friction	Not every traveler wants an account or a complex setup	Organizer-led trip, guest access, share links
Resilience	Remote trips create poor connectivity and delayed updates	Offline queue, idempotent sync, visible status
Change confidence	Cancellations and drop-outs cause manual recalculation	Refund cascades, what-if simulation, event history
Payment completion	Knowing someone owes money is not the same as collecting it	UPI hand-off, status, and reconciliation
Portability	Users need records after the trip	Audit PDF, CSV, receipts, source-linked events

5.2 Willingness to pay: what is known and unknown

The market supports a cautious premium hypothesis. Splitwise monetizes receipt scanning and convenience features through Pro; TravelSpend and Settle Up expose premium features or lifetime/group plans; Tricount competes with a free-core message. These signals suggest users may pay to reduce high-friction work, but they do not establish a TULIS price or conversion rate. [4] [6] [20] [24]

The recommended test is not a basic-use paywall. Test a generous core and compare three packages: a free trip ledger, a per-trip/group pass for advanced reconciliation and audit, and an individual subscription for recurring travelers. Measure paid conversion after a completed trip, not after sign-up.

6 Business model and go-to-market

6.1 Initial segment

Start with India domestic leisure trips among friends and families coordinating multi-day travel. This segment is narrow enough for direct discovery and benefits from UPI familiarity, yet broad enough to surface unequal participation, group payments, and itinerary change.

6.2 Acquisition loop

The organizer is the first user. Create a trip in under two minutes, invite participants through a link or code, allow non-account guests to view or contribute appropriately, and give the group a useful summary before asking for payment. A completed audit PDF or settlement link can become a post-trip retention and referral artifact.

6.3 Monetization experiments

Model	Hypothesis	Primary metric
Free core	Removes adoption friction and seeds group growth	Trip activation and invite completion
Per-trip pass	Group pays when reconciliation or export becomes valuable	Paid conversion after trip completion
Recurring subscription	Frequent organizers need multi-trip history and automation	Repeat-trip retention and annual revenue
Payment-linked revenue	Settlement convenience may support a small net revenue stream	Successful reconciliations minus payment/support cost

7 Validation roadmap

Phase	Work	Decision gate
0–30 days	Interview 20–30 organizers and participants; observe current spreadsheets, chats, and split apps; test guest access and refund scenarios	Confirm top three repeated pain points
31–60 days	Run 5–10 trip pilots; instrument invite completion, expense volume, corrections, offline sync, refund resolution, and settlement completion	Prove workflow reliability and activation
61–90 days	Test pricing packages, UPI hand-off, audit exports, and repeat-trip behavior	Choose monetization and launch wedge
Post-90 days	Scale one acquisition channel; compare TULIS against incumbent workflows with matched trip cohorts	Demonstrate retention, paid conversion, and lower reconciliation burden

7.1 Success metrics

1. Activation: organizer creates a trip and adds at least three participants.
2. Collaboration: invite acceptance, guest participation, and percentage of trips with multi-user activity.
3. Ledger quality: expense correction rate, duplicate rate, unresolved anomaly rate, and zero-sum discrepancy.
4. Reliability: offline queue replay success, duplicate event rate, sync latency, and support contacts per trip.
5. Completion: percentage of trips reaching a settled or explicitly closed state.
6. Monetization: paid conversion after trip completion, revenue per completed trip, support cost per paid group, and repeat-trip retention.

8 Risks and strategic decisions

8.1 Risks

1. Market definitions can inflate the apparent opportunity if travel GDP, bookings, group-travel estimates, T&E software, bill-splitting forecasts, and UPI throughput are combined.
2. Competitor parity is high for offline entry, multi-currency, receipts, exports, custom splits, and debt minimization.
3. TULIS-specific demand for refund cascades, event sourcing, anomaly detection, and UPI reconciliation remains a hypothesis.
4. Payment access, status confirmation, provider terms, costs, consent, and regulatory obligations may constrain UPI functionality.
5. A financial product earns trust through correctness and recovery. Incorrect balances, duplicate events, privacy failures, or opaque AI changes could damage adoption.

8.2 Strategic decisions to make next

1. Choose whether the first product promise is “trip expenses without disputes” or “trip planning with a living ledger.” The second is broader; the first may be easier to test.
2. Decide whether a non-account guest can contribute expenses, view balances, or only receive summaries.
3. Define the minimum reliable UPI integration and its supported geography before marketing automated settlement.
4. Choose a free-core limit that protects adoption and a premium feature that removes a costly, observable pain.
5. Set a data policy for receipts, location context, AI prompts, and shared-member visibility.

9 Final recommendation

Build TULIS as a focused India-first trip-ledger product, not as a generic expense splitter and not as an enterprise T&E suite. Keep core capture and group participation easy. Make the differentiation visible during the moments when ordinary apps become stressful: unequal shares, offline changes, refunds, disputes, and the transition from a calculated balance to an auditable settlement. Fund the next decision with real trip pilots and bottom-up economics rather than a larger top-down TAM claim.



- [1]: <https://www.phocuswright.com/Travel-Research/Market-Overview-Sizing/Global-Travel-Market-Report-2025> “Phocuswright, Global Travel Market Report 2025” [2]: <https://www.phocuswright.com/Travel-Research/Research-Updates/2025/1-2-T-dollars-in-online-bookings-by-end-of-2026> “Phocuswright, online travel bookings outlook” [3]: <https://wtcc.org/news/global-travel-and-tourism-is-strong-despite-economic-headwinds> “WTTC, global Travel & Tourism 2024 contribution” [4]: <https://wtcc.org/research/economic-impact> “WTTC, Economic Impact Research” [5]: <https://www.marketresearchfuture.com/reports/group-travel-market-33138> “Market Research Future,

Group Travel Market" [6]: <https://www.ustravel.org/business-and-group-travel> "U.S. Travel Association, Business and Group Travel" [7]: <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/press-release/global-travel-expense-management-software-market> "Grand View Research, travel and expense management software" [8]: <https://www.technavio.com/report/bill-splitting-apps-market-industry-analysis> "Technavio, Bill Splitting Apps Market" [9]: https://data.tourism.gov.in/mrd/Uploads/tourism_data/India%20Tourism%20Data%20Compendium%202025_1.pdf "India Tourism Data Compendium 2025" [10]: https://www.ey.com/en_in/insights/media-entertainment/the-great-indian-traveller-trends-shaping-the-way-india-travels "EY, Indian traveller trends" [11]: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2257087®=3&lang=2> "Government of India, UPI and digital payments release" [12]: https://www.business-standard.com/finance/news/upi-transactions-august-2026-record-volume-npci-126090100506_1.html "Business Standard, August 2026 UPI activity" [13]: <https://www.reuters.com/world/india/india-bars-bank-charges-upi-payments-up-2000-rupees-2026-09-14/> "Reuters, India UPI payments report" [14]: <https://www.phocuswright.com/Travel-Research/Technology-Innovation/The-State-of-Global-Travel-Payments-2024> "Phocuswright, State of Global Travel Payments 2024" [15]: <https://www.splitwise.com/about> "Splitwise, product overview" [16]: <https://apps.apple.com/us/app/splitwise/id458023433> "Splitwise, U.S. App Store listing" [17]: <https://kb.splitwise.com/pro/what-is-splitwise-pro> "Splitwise Help Center, Pro features" [18]: <https://press.bunq.com/246589-from-roommates-to-road-trips-tricount-tallies-16-4-billion-shared-in-2024/> "bunq, Tricount 2024 activity announcement" [19]: <https://tricount.com/en-us/> "Tricount official product page" [20]: https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.tribab.tricount.android&hl=en_US "Tricount Google Play listing" [21]: <https://travel-spend.com/> "TravelSpend official product page" [22]: <https://help.travel-spend.com/cost-splitting/1CG3814nPkQNEu8jUHZxMY/how-to-split-costs--settle-debts-in-a-group/6k7kvbAnTPygGddSZrUZkC> "TravelSpend Help Center, splitting and settlement" [23]: <https://splid.app/english> "Splid official product page" [24]: <https://apps.apple.com/us/app/settle-up-group-expenses/id737534985> "Settle Up U.S. App Store listing" [25]: <https://ir.expensify.com/news-releases/news-release-details/expensify-announces-q4-and-full-year-fiscal-2025-results/> "Expensify, FY2025 results" [26]: <https://help.expensify.com/articles/new-expensify/billing-and-subscriptions/explore-plans-subscriptions-and-pricing/Understand-Expensify-Pricing.html> "Expensify, pricing documentation" [27]: <https://press.priceline.com/new-priceline-research-finds-average-traveler-spends-two-full-work-days-to-plan-and-book-trips/> "Priceline and Harris Poll, trip-planning time" [28]: <https://gocity.com/en/blog/trip-planning-consumer-habits-usa> "Go City, trip-planning consumer survey" [29]: <https://www.experian.com/blogs/ask-experian/survey-financial-stress-of-traveling-with-friends/> "Experian, financial stress of traveling with friends"

End of market analysis · TULIS